4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: December 2025. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

December 2025 Locked December 2025 is locked (closed 5 Jan 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

December's jobs made $65,657 gross margin (43.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $22,821 and overheads $57,350, leaving ($14,514) profit before tax ((9.7%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 53.3% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$65,657
Technician wages and on-costs	$65,117
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$42,296
Technician time not charged to jobs	$22,821
Gross profit (the P&L)	$42,836
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$57,350
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($14,514)
Revenue	$150,283
Gross margin on jobs, %	43.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(9.7%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**53.3%**

Line: All

December against December last year
(5.7%)
$150,283 against $159,406

Year to date (Jul to Dec 2025)
$995,598
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
43.9%
$436,940 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is $995,598 this financial year to date (Jul to Dec 2025). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.8%); Installations the lowest (35.4%). The business needs 53.3% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 35.4% gross margin, 0.4 points over the 35.0% target ($2,295 ahead on $617,100 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($66,849 ahead on $231,900 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

December against December last year
45.0%
$40,100 against $27,650

Year to date (Jul to Dec 2025)
$231,900
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
63.8%
$148,014 before overheads

What it shows
Maintenance contracts brought in $231,900 this financial year to date, at a 63.8% gross margin (above the 43.9% overall).

What you'd do about it
Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($66,849 ahead on $231,900 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

December against December last year
(24.7%)
$78,100 against $103,700

Year to date (Jul to Dec 2025)
$617,100
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
35.4%
$218,280 before overheads

What it shows
Installations brought in $617,100 this financial year to date, at a 35.4% gross margin (below the 43.9% overall).

What you'd do about it
Installations: 35.4% gross margin, 0.4 points over the 35.0% target ($2,295 ahead on $617,100 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

December against December last year
14.4%
$32,083 against $28,056

Year to date (Jul to Dec 2025)
$146,598
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
48.2%
$70,646 before overheads

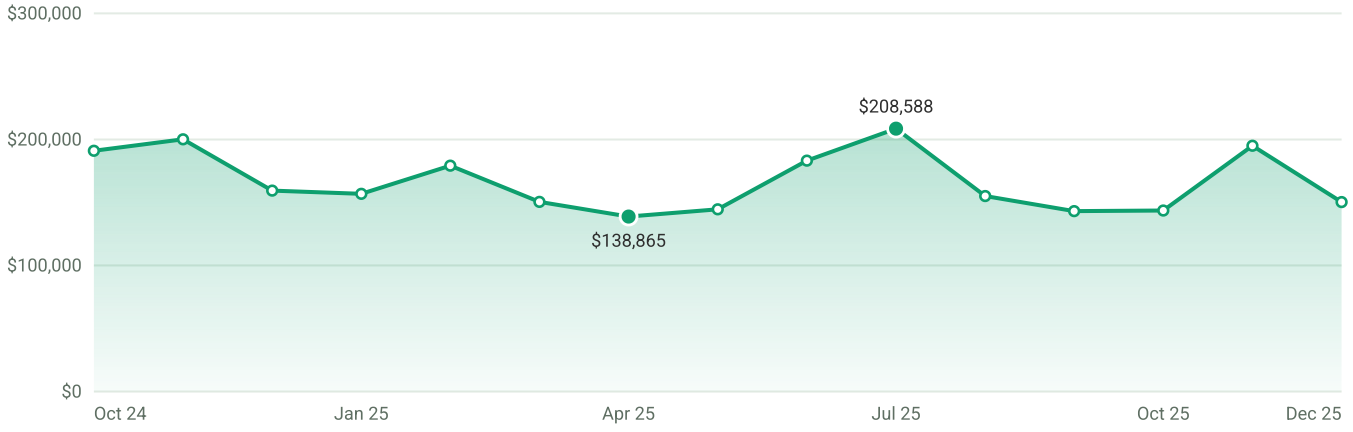
What it shows
Call-outs and repairs brought in $146,598 this financial year to date, at a 48.2% gross margin (above the 43.9% overall).

What you'd do about it
Call-outs and repairs: 48.2% gross margin, 13.2 points over the 35.0% target ($19,337 ahead on $146,598 this financial year to date).

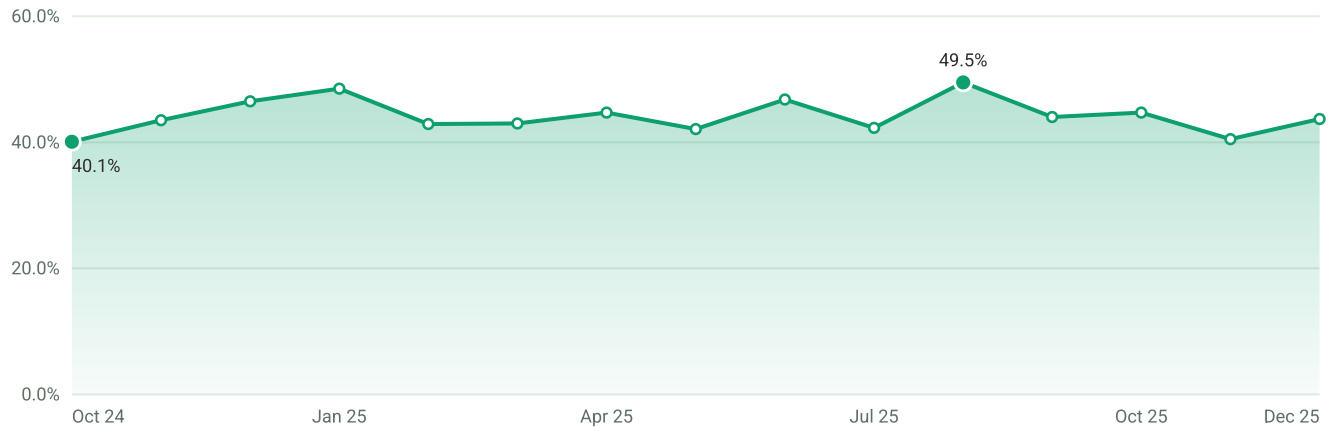
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Dec 2025) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$231,900	–	–	$148,014	63.8%
Installations	$617,100	–	–	$218,280	35.4%
Call-outs and repairs	$146,598	–	–	$70,646	48.2%
Total	$995,598	–	–	$436,940	43.9%

Same period last year: Not available: the data starts October 2024.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.